

JAMES TAYLOR

AN EVENING WITH JAMES TAYLOR AND HIS ALL-STAR BAND

Cumberland County Civic Center

Portland, Maine

Saturday, October 12, 2019

Presented by Portland Arts and Entertainment

ARTIST BIOGRAPHY

James Taylor was born March 12, 1948, in Boston, Massachusetts, and raised in Chapel Hill, North Carolina. He emerged in the late 1960s as one of the defining voices of the singer-songwriter movement, releasing his debut album on Apple Records in 1968 before signing to Warner Bros. His 1970 album *Sweet Baby James* made him one of the most celebrated musicians of his generation and established a sound that blended folk, soft rock, and soul in a way that felt deeply personal and entirely his own.

Taylor has won five Grammy Awards and sold more than one hundred million records worldwide. His most recognized songs include *Fire and Rain*, *You've Got a Friend*, *Carolina in My Mind*, *How Sweet It Is (To Be Loved by You)*, and *Mexico*. He received the Presidential Medal of Freedom in 2015.

He continues to tour extensively with his all-star band and is widely regarded as one of the greatest live performers of his era.

SETLIST -- OCTOBER 12, 2019

(As performed; order from memory, noted by J. Lawton after the show)

First Half:

Something in the Way She Moves

Carolina in My Mind

Sweet Baby James

Shower the People

You've Got a Friend

Country Road

Blossom

Don't Let Me Be Lonely Tonight

Steamroller Blues

Intermission (approximately 20 minutes)

Second Half:

Mexico

Fire and Rain

Long Ago and Far Away

Your Smiling Face

Handy Man

How Sweet It Is (To Be Loved by You)

October Road

New Hymn
Copperline

Encore:
Going to Carolina
Up on the Roof

NOTES IN THE MARGIN (written by Joanne Lawton during and after the show)

Harry would have stayed on his feet for this whole thing. He always did.

"Sweet Baby James" -- he played it slower than I remembered from the record, or maybe I have always heard it faster in my head because of how Harry used to hum it while he was doing things around the house. Either way, it was right. It was exactly right.

He talked to the audience in between songs the way people talk who are not afraid of silence. Small stories, gentle jokes. He is 71 years old and he is still someone who seems to be at peace inside his own voice.

"Fire and Rain" made Karen cry next to me. She was 23 when Harry and I first played her that album and she still knows all the words.

I did not expect "New Hymn." It is not one of his most famous songs but I have always loved it. "May the light of morning find you, pure in heart and strong of mind." I have that line in my head still.

The Civic Center was full. The man to my left was probably seventy years old and knew every word of every song. The woman behind me cried through the second half. We were all there for the same reason.

We went to The Sail Loft on Commercial Street afterward, Karen and David and me, because Harry's birthday was the same week. We ordered chowder and raised a glass to him.

I am glad I went. I am glad Karen made me buy the tickets when she first said we should go, because I was going to hesitate over the cost and I would have regretted it.

TICKET INFORMATION

Tickets: Section B, Row 12, Seats 14 and 15
Face value: \$89.00 each
Purchased: August 2019 through Ticketmaster
Venue: Cumberland County Civic Center, Portland, Maine